



Essential oils and seizures

Scientists have discovered evidence suggesting some essential oils contribute to seizure disorders. <http://digit.in/may21-31>



Dogs can sniff out coronavirus

A proof-of-concept study showed that dogs identified positive coronavirus samples with 96% accuracy. <http://digit.in/may21-32>



Reducing Colon cancer Morbidity

Artificial intelligence diagnostics in endoscopy can improve the healthcare provided to colon cancer patients

Aditya Madanapalle | aditya@digit.in

The Asian Institute of Gastroenterology provides procedures and treatments not available anywhere else in India, and gets patients from the surrounding countries including Sri Lanka, Bangladesh, Malaysia and Nepal, and is one of the best super-specialty clinics in the world. The mission of the institute is to provide world class healthcare at affordable costs. Apart from providing treat-

ment, the institute is also involved in research and outreach. A large part of the population live in remote and rural areas, and may not have access to the best healthcare, especially with the specialised knowledge and equipment needed for colonoscopy. As a result regular screenings and tests that can detect signs of cancer early, and prevent or treat it more effectively, are not available to local patients. Within the colon are clumps of cells called polyps, most of them are perfectly normal, though a few grow out of control and can become cancerous, and even fatal. Catching these abnormal polyps early is what is needed.

Another problem is that there are simply too few endoscopists in

the country to adequately cover the population. The Japanese Ministry of Internal Affairs and Communications in collaboration with the medtech company Olympus Corporation, initiated a training and research program that hoped to use AI to address these problems. Through the project, local doctors learned the techniques used for AI diagnosis, and were also trained on transferring that knowledge to the next generation of endoscopists. The initiative began in October 2020, and Olympus Corporation provided the clinic with some high tech equipment, including the Endocytos ultra-magnifying scope that allows real time observation of processes within living cells. Along with that, there are the AI platforms for diagnosis, EndoBRAIN